2021年12月大学英语四级考试真题(第2套)

Part I Writing (30 minutes)

Directions: *Suppose your university student union is planning to hold a speech contest. You are now to write a proposal for organizing the contest. The proposal may include the topic, aim, procedure and selection of contestants. You will have 30 minutes to write the proposal. You should write at least **120** words but no more than **180** words.*

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Part II Listening Comprehension (25 minutes)

Section A

Directions: *In this section, you will hear three news reports. At the end of each news report, you will hear two or three questions. Both the news report and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.*

Questions 1 and 2 are based on the news report you have just heard.

1. A. She was pierced by a chicken bone.
   B. She was coughing all the time.
   C. She suffered from lung cancer.
   D. She suffered from shock.
2. A. By eating chicken soup daily.
   B. Through regular exercising.
   C. Through a surgical operation.
   D. By using traditional Chinese medicine.

Questions 3 and 4 are based on the news report you have just heard.

3. A. It was born 13 years ago.
   B. It was Alice Gray's lovely pet.
   C. It got injured in a big bushfire.
   D. It ran away into a nearby forest.
4. A. They rebuilt the fencing around their farm.
   B. They spent seven years replanting their farm.
   C. They claimed damages for their heavy losses.
   D. They installed a camera to monitor sheep activity.

Questions 5 to 7 are based on the news report you have just heard.

5. A. The disappearance of some gold and diamonds.
   B. The transfer of tons of precious metal by air.
   C. The crash of a Russian cargo airplane.
   D. The loss of gold from an airplane.
6. A. It made an emergency landing.
   B. It informed the local police at once.
   C. It contacted the goldmine company.
   D. It had a crew member fix the problem.
7. A. They will cooperate with the police.
   B. They had checked the plane carefully.
   C. They will be questioned by the police.
   D. They took some gold bars and diamonds.

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you will hear two long conversations. At the end of each conversation, you will hear four questions. Both the conversation and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on* ***Answer Sheet 1*** *with a single line through the centre.*

Questions 8 to 11 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

8. A. For the company's records.
   B. For future training purposes.
   C. To follow the company's rule.
   D. To ensure information security.
9. A. To check her customer reference number.
   B. To inquire about the price of office chairs.
   C. To get her money back for the returned chair.
   D. To make complaints about its customer service.
10. A. She had to update its information.
    B. She forgot where she had left it.
    C. She lost it about three days ago.
    D. She was issued a new card.
11. A. Reconsider her options for payment methods.
    B. Make a specific note on the company's system.
    C. Update her bank card details on the company's website.
    D. Upload her personal information to the company's website.

Questions 12 to 15 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

12. A. He is feeling exhausted.
    B. He is tired of cooking.
    C. He has to work late.
    D. He wants to try Asian foods.
13. A. Book a table.
    B. Order a delivery.
    C. Download a menu.
    D. Locate a restaurant.
14. A. It is not tasty.
    B. It is not healthy.
    C. It is too oily.
    D. It is too spicy.
15. A. She is too concerned about money.
    B. She is too weight-conscious.
    C. She is too picky about food.
    D. She is too eager to please.

Section C

Directions: *In this section, you will hear three passages. At the end of each passage, you will hear three or four questions. Both the passage and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on* ***Answer Sheet 1*** *with a single line through the centre.*

Questions 16 to 18 are based on the passage you have just heard.

16. A. Owners' personalities affect their cats' behaviour and wellbeing.
    B. Parents' personalities can affect the personalities of their children.
    C. Parents and cat owners alike experience high levels of anxiety.
    D. More and more people are treating pet cats like their children.
17. A. Give their pets behavioural training.
    B. Provide their pets with the best care.
    C. Know their pets' feelings and desires.
    D. Interact with their pets in novel ways.
18. A. More convincing explanation.
    B. More extensive sampling.
    C. Collection of more data.
    D. Further investigation.

Questions 19 to 21 are based on the passage you have just heard.

19. A. People should do more running than mere walking.
    B. Running is the best exercise for extending one's life.

C. People should exercise at least 60 minutes every day.
D. Running is the easiest form of exercise for most people.

20. A. Improving their brain function.
B. Regulating their breathing rate.
C. Slowing down their ageing process.
D. Accelerating their blood circulation.

21. A. They found it easy to control their emotions.
B. They struggled to handle negative emotions.
C. They were more eager to enjoy a movie.
D. They were less affected by sad movies.

Questions 22 to 25 are based on the passage you have just heard.

22. A. He is a tour guide.
B. He is a famous architect.
C. He is a local entrepreneur.
D. He is the owner of the Hill House.

23. A. He studied the blueprints of other famous buildings.
B. He inquired about his client's family background.
C. He observed his client's life and habits.
D. He took a tour of his client's old home.

24. A. A house made of timber and brick.
B. A house with a lot of free space.
C. A house of the current fashion.
D. A house of a unique design.

25. A. They are well preserved and in pretty good shape.
B. They are copies built to the architect's designs.
C. They were designed by another architect.
D. They were badly damaged but restored.

Part III Reading Comprehension (40 minutes)

Section A

Directions: *In this section, there is a passage with ten blanks. You are required to select one word for each blank from a list of choices given in a word bank following the passage. Read the passage through carefully before making your choices. Each choice in the bank is identified by a letter. Please mark the corresponding letter for each item on* ***Answer Sheet 2*** *with a single line through the centre. You may not use any of the words in the bank more than once.*

Questions 26 to 35 are based on the following passage.

It is commonly believed that the great English dramatist and poet William Shakespeare was born in Stratford-on-Avon on April 23, 1564. But it is impossible to know the __26__ day on which he was born.

Church records show he's *baptized* (施洗礼) on April 26, and 3 days was a customary amount of time to wait before baptizing a newly born baby. Shakespeare's date of death is __27__ known, however: it was April 23, 1616. He was 52 and had retired to Stratford three years before.

Although few plays have been performed or analyzed as extensively as the 38 plays Shakespeare wrote, there are few surviving details about his life. This __28__ of biographical information is due primarily to his social __29__: he was not a noble, but the son of a leather trader.

Shakespeare __30__ attended the grammar school in Stratford, where he would have studied Latin and read __31__ literature. He did not go to university and at age 18 married Anne Hathaway, who was eight years his __32__. They had four children, including the twins, Hamnet and Judith. Nothing is known of the period between the birth of the twins and Shakespeare's __33__ as a dramatist in London

in the early 1590s.

In a million words written over 20 years, he __34__ the full range of human emotions and conflicts with a __35__ that remains sharp today. As his great contemporary the poet and dramatist Ben Jonson said, "He was not of an age, but for all time.

A. captured	I. precision
B. classical	J. probably
C. conclusively	K. quality
D. emergence	L. scarcity
E. exact	M. senior
F. generated	N. separated
G. particular	O. systematically
H. position	

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you are going to read a passage with ten statements attached to it. Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph more than once. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the questions by marking the corresponding letter on* ***Answer Sheet 2****.*

How to not be boring

A) Humans are creatures of habit. We love to establish a routine and stick with it. Then we often put ourselves on auto-pilot. Routines can be incredibly useful in helping you get things done. However, too much of a routine can also make you incredibly boring. Nevertheless, many people live lives that are boringly predictable, or live a life where everything is outlined or planned.

B) To tell the truth, interesting people are more popular among their friends. If you don't arouse someone's curiosity or brighten someone's day, you probably come across as being a little bit dull. But that doesn't mean your life has ended and you can't do anything to change it. If you find yourself searching for something to say beyond small talk, try these tactics to find more interesting approaches to conversation.

C) Recently, I was at a gathering of colleagues when someone turned to me and asked, "So, what's new with you?" Ordinarily, I think I' m a good conversationalist. After all, it's literally my job to talk to people and tell their stories or share their advice. And that's not exactly an unexpected question. Still, the only "new-to-me" topics that came to mind were my daughter's basketball *tournament* (锦标赛) and my feelings about that morning's political headlines—neither amusing nor appropriate topics at that moment.

D) Oh, no, I thought. Have I become boring? But sharing our experiences in an authentic way to connect with other people is what makes us interesting, says associate professor Michael Pirson. The hesitation I felt in not sharing the ordinary things that were happening in my life, and the wild mental search for something more interesting, may have backfired and made me seem less interesting.

E) "If someone is making up some conversation that might be interesting, it's probably not going to land well," says Pirson, whose expertise includes trust and well-being, mindfulness, and humanistic management. "It's going to feel like a made-up conversation that people don't necessarily want to tune in to."

F) The most interesting people aren't those who've gone on some Eat, Pray, Love journey to find themselves. Instead, Pirson says, they're those who examine the ordinary. "Often, the 'boring things' may not be boring at all. Maybe they are actually little miracles," he says. Share your observations about the world around you—interesting stories you heard or things you noticed—and you may be surprised by the universal connection they inspire.

G) This is essentially how Jessica Hagy starts her day. The author of *How to Be Interesting: An Instruction Manual*, Hagy spends a lot of time thinking about what's interesting to her. People who are interesting are persistently curious, she says.

H) Think about the everyday things around you and ask questions about them. What is that roadside monument I see on my way to work every day? Who built that interesting building in my city? What nearby attractions haven't I visited? Why do people do things that way? Use what you find to ask more questions and learn more about the world around you. "Having that sort of curiosity is almost like a protective gear from getting into boredom," she says. And when you find things that are truly interesting to you, share them.

I) Television veteran Audrey Morrissey, executive producer of NBC's *The Voice*, is always looking for what will make a person or story interesting to viewers: It's usually a matter of individuality. "Having a strong point of view, signature style, or being a super-enthusiast in a particular field makes someone interesting," she says. That means embracing what is truly interesting or unique about yourself. "Many people are 'not boring' in the way that they can carry a conversation or can be good at a social gathering, etc. To be interesting means that you have lived life, taken risks, traveled, sought out experience to learn for yourself and share with others," she says.

J) Of course, it's possible to be a fountain of knowledge and a boring person, says public relations consultant Andrea Pass. Paying attention to the listener is an important part of having a conversation that's interesting to both parties. Talking on and on about what's interesting to you isn't going to make you an interesting person, she says.

K) "If the listener is not paying attention, it's your sign to shorten the story or change direction. Make sure to bring the audience into the conversation so that it is not one-sided," Pass says. Be a better listener yourself, and give others opportunities to participate in the conversation by inviting them with questions or requests to share their own experiences or thoughts. (e.g., "Now, tell me about your favorite book," or "Have you ever been to that attraction?") Questions are a powerful tool, especially when they encourage others to disclose information about themselves. A 2012 study from the University of California, Santa Barbara, fom1d that roughly 40% of the time we are talking, we're disclosing subjective information about our experience.知 d when we're doing so, our brains are more engaged. So one strategy to leave others with the impression that you're a sparkling conversation partner is to get others to talk about themselves.

L) Being relatable is also essential, Morrissey says. "The best entertainment and storytelling comes from people who are relatable- those who don't shy away from opening up but freely share who they are and what they care about. These are the people viewers most relate to and find interesting. Being authentic, honest, and vulnerable is always interesting."

M) I have now come to realize that being boring, in actuality, is not only about who you are as a person, but also how you present yourself. No matter what, make sure you are having fun in life. Because when you are enjoying, people around you will begin to enjoy as well. Show some interest in them and they will definitely show some in you. If you are a very reserved person, this could be a little difficult at first. But with a little effort, you can definitely improve.

36. Pirson claims that some ordinary things may often prove to be miraculously interesting.
37. To make a conversation interesting, it is important that you listen to the other party attentively.
38. A person who is unable to stimulate others' curiosity or make their life enjoyable may appear somewhat boring.
39. Interesting people usually possess certain unique qualities, according to a TV program producer.
40. Be interested in others and they are sure to be interested in you.
41. The author considers himself usually good at conducting conversations.
42. Interesting people are always full of curiosity.
43. Falling into a routine can ttm1 a person into an utter bore.
44. One strategy to be a good conversationalist is to motivate your partner to tell their own stories.
45. Interesting as it might appear, a made-up conversation will probably turn out to be dull.

Section C

Directions: *There are 2 passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions or unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A), B), C) and D). You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on* ***Answer Sheet 2*** *with a single line through the centre.*

Passage One

Questions 46 and 50 are based on the following passage.

With obesity now affecting 29% of the population in England, and expected to rise to 35% by 2030, should we now recognise it as a disease? Obesity, in which excess body fat has accumulated to such an extent that health may be adversely affected, meets the dictionary definition of disease, argues Professor John Wilding. He points out that more than 200 genes influence weight. "Thus body weight is strongly influenced by biology- it is not an individual's fault if they develop obesity." Yet the widespread view is that obesity is self-induced and that it is entirely the individual's responsibility to do something about it. Recognising obesity as a chronic disease with severe complications rather than a lifestyle choice "should help reduce the *stigma* (耻辱) and discrimination experienced by many people with obesity," he adds.

Professor Wilding disagrees that labelling a high proportion of the population as having a disease removes personal responsibility or may overwhelm health services, pointing out that other common diseases, such as high blood pressure and diabetes, require people to take action to manage their condition. He suggests that most people with obesity will eventually develop complications. "But unless we accept that obesity is a disease, we are not going to be able to tackle it," he concludes.

But Dr. Richard Pile, a physician with a special interest in diabetes, argues that adopting this approach "could actually result in worse outcomes for individuals and society." He believes that the dictionary definition of disease "is so vague that we can classify almost anything as a disease" and says the question is not whether we can, but whether we should, and to what end.

If labelling obesity as a disease was harmless then it wouldn't really matter, he writes. But labelling obesity as a disease "risks reducing autonomy, disempowering and robbing people of the *intrinsic* (内在的) motivation that is such an important enabler of change." What's more, making obesity a disease "may not benefit patients, but it will benefit healthcare providers and the *pharmaceutical* (制药的) industry when health insurance and clinical guidelines promote treatment with drugs and surgery," he warns.

46. What does Professor John Wilding argue about obesity?

A. Its impact on society is expected to rise.

B. It is now too widespread to be neglected.
C. It should be regarded as a genetic disease.
D. Its dictionary definition should be updated.

47. What is the popular view of obesity?
A. It is difficult to define.
B. It is a modern disease.
C. It has much to do with one's genes.
D. It results from a lack of self-control.

48. Why are some people opposed to labelling obesity as a disease?
A. Obese people would not feel responsible to take any action.
B. Obese people would not be able to afford the medical costs.
C. Obese people would be overwhelmed with anxiety.
D. Obese people would be discriminated against.

49. What does Dr. Richard Pile think of the dictionary definition of disease?
A. It is of no use in understanding obesity.
B. It is too inclusive and thus lacks clarity.
C. It helps little to solve patients' problems.
D. It matters little to the debate over obesity.

50. What is Dr. Richard Pile's concern about classifying obesity as a disease?
A. It may affect obese people's quality of life.
B. It may accelerate the spread of obesity.
C. It may cause a shortage of doctors.
D. It may do little good to patients.

Passage Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

Nationwide, only about three percent of early childhood teachers are male in the U. S. Experts say this can have an impact on young children whose understanding of gender roles and identity are rapidly forming. Research has found that having access to diverse teachers is beneficial for children. For the youngest learners, it means they are more likely to get exposed to different varieties of play and communication. It also helps them develop healthy ideas around gender.

"In our world and our society, we have very specific *stereotypes* (模式化形象) of gender roles," said Mindi Reich-Shapiro, an assistant professor in the teacher education department of the Borough of Manhattan Community College, and one of the authors of a recent study. "It's important for children to see other possibilities and other paths they can take."

Despite mostly feeling supported by colleagues and family members, many of the male educators surveyed in the study reported facing social or cultural resistance in their careers as early education teachers. Some also reported that there were parents surprised or concerned that their child had a male teacher. And they had been advised by colleagues or other staff not to hug children.

Reich-Shapiro and fellow researchers made several recommendations to increase male representation in the field. Low pay has long been acknowledged as a major issue in the early childhood field. Over 70% of male educators who said they intended to stay in the early education workforce noted an increased salary was a major motivating factor for them to commit to the career long-term. The report suggests paying all early childhood educators the way elementary school teachers are paid

Cities and programs should establish support groups for male early childhood educators and provide mentoring and professional development advice for male educators and their program leaders.

The authors also suggest that traditional recruitment approaches for early childhood educators "do not address the gender gap in the field." They recommend providing young men opportunities to work with children through training and volunteer programs, targeting groups of men who are considering a career change, such as fathers.

51. What do we learn from the first paragraph about early childhood education in the U. S.?
A. It helps raise children's awareness of gender roles.
B. It exposes children to different ways of interaction.
C. It is negatively impacted by a lack of male teachers.
D. It clearly aims to form children's identity through play.
52. What does Mindi Reich-Shapiro emphasize in her comment on childhood education?
A. The importance of broadening children's horizons.
B. The responsibilities of fathers for children's growth.
C. The urgency of creating teacher education programs.
D. The role of teachers in motivating children to learn.
53. What do we learn about male teachers from their responses in the study?
A. Some of them find it awkward when hugging children.
B. They feel pressured to keep up with female colleagues.
C. They find it hard to meet the expectations of kids' parents.
D. Many of them feel prejudiced against socially and culturally.
54. What is needed for men to commit to early childhood education?
A. Higher pay.
B. Job security.
C. Social recognition.
D. Better working conditions.
55. What do the authors of the study recommend to bridge the gender gap in early childhood education?
A. Recruiting young men who have a passion for education young children.
B. Taking measures to attract prospective male teachers to work in the field.
C. Persuading prospective fathers to consider a change in their career.
D. Providing male teachers with more opportunities for advancement.

Part IV Translation (30 minutes)

Directions: *For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on* ***Answer Sheet 2****.*

坎儿井(Karez)是新疆干旱地区的一种水利系统，由地下渠道将水井连接而成。该系统将春夏季节**渗入**(seep into)地下的大量雨水及积雪融水收集起来，通过山体的自然坡度引到地面，用于灌溉农田和满足人们的日常用水需求。坎儿井减少了水在地面的**蒸发**(evaporation)，对地表破坏很小，因而有效地保护了自然资源与生态环境。坎儿井体现了我国人民与自然和谐共存的智慧，是对人类文明的一大贡献。

KEYS

Part I Writing

Suggested Version

Dear Sir or Madam:

I'm Jill, a second-year student from Business Department. I'm writing to make a proposal about holding a college-wide English public speaking contest with the topic of "University as I see it".

The aims of the contest are twofold. First, students all over the University are offered an opportunity to demonstrate their ability to communicate effectively in English. Second, the contest could serve as a forum for students from different background to share their insights and experiences. It is important to note that only a current undergraduate student is eligible for the contest. Each of the contestants would be asked to deliver a prepared speech of 5 minutes and an impromptu speech based on the topic assigned after the prepared speech. The contest would be an off-line event at the International Conference Hall. A panel from the ESL faculty shall select five finalists from all participants. The finalists would present their speeches after which three winners (and two honorable mentions) would be chosen.

I'm looking forward to your reply. Thank you very much for everything you've done. Wish you all the best.

Yours sincerely,
Jill

Part II Listening Comprehension

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
B	C	D	A	D	A	C	B	C	D
11	**12**	**13**	**14**	**15**	**16**	**17**	**18**	**19**	**20**
C	A	B	D	C	A	B	D	B	A
21	**22**	**23**	**24**	**25**					
D	A	C	D	B					

Part III Reading Comprehension

26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35
E	C	L	H	J	B	M	D	A	I
36	**37**	**38**	**39**	**40**	**41**	**42**	**43**	**44**	**45**
F	J	B	I	M	C	G	A	K	E
46	**47**	**48**	**49**	**50**	**51**	**52**	**53**	**54**	**55**
C	D	A	B	D	C	A	D	A	B

Part IV Translation

Karez is a water conservancy system in the arid area of Xinjiang. It is formed by underground channels connecting wells. The system collects a large amount of rainwater and snow melt water that seep into the ground in spring and summer, and draws it to the ground through the natural slope of the mountain to irrigate farmland and meet people's daily water needs. Karez reduces the evaporation of

water on the ground and does little damage to the surface, thus effectively protecting the natural resources and the ecological environment. Karez embodies the wisdom of the harmonious coexistence of our people and nature, and is a great contribution to human civilization.